

Torq Arena — Game Ideas, Graded

Idea-level scale: **Best** • **Good** • **Low** • **Cut** (was "Ignore" — renamed to Cut to match the Notion [games.csv](#) table; **TorqSiege**, **TorqCapture** and **TorqBall** sit outside the scale as **Ungraded**, pending their prototype gates — the collapse test, the zone-scoring bench test, and the ball/boards test (+ a separate Grabber bench test) respectively). Grades are a working read from our vetting — change in Notion/here as the event firms up.

Grading synced to Notion "Torq Arena — Game Ideas" (source of truth), 3 Sep 2026.

Game	It's basically	Type	Idea Level	How it plays	Why it works
TorqBall	Rocket League	Arena	Ungraded (pending ball/boards test)	Standalone tournament (group → knockouts → final); teams push a giant glowing ball into goals on a boarded pitch — Standard 2v2/3v3 (default), Duel 1v1 (tiebreaker/hype final), Big Party 4v4/6v6 (exhibition scrum); a boost system (Plow/Scoop/Grabber/Turbo/Magnet) earned off lit floor pads adds chaos for Big Party + the stretch Rumble mode	Zero skill wall + team energy + the poster/reel shot potential — the widest-appeal concept in the set, with a full standalone doc set (rulebook, ball/boards prototype gate, boost system, needs/cost roll-up); graded once the Ball & Boards Test (and the separate Grabber bench test) prove the physics, same treatment as TorqSiege/TorqCapture.
TorqFall	Fall Guys	Arena	Best	6–8 cars per heat through a chaos gauntlet (rulebook §2); elimination / first-to-finish	Chaos hides mistakes; huge throughput; overhead pile-up = content gold
TorqSiege	Castle build-and-smash	Arena	Ungraded (pending collapse test)	Teams build a foam/cardboard castle, opponents smash it with RC cars; topple the core	Best reel in the bank + no failure state; graded once the collapse test proves the physics

Game	It's basically	Type	Idea Level	How it plays	Why it works
TorqCapture	Call of Duty objective modes	Arena	Ungraded (pending bench test)	Two teams fight over lit zones; occupy → hold the majority → the ring flips colour + ticks points; a 5-mode COD-style playlist (Domination / Hotzone / The Hill / Siege Point / Courier)	Only true team-vs-team game in the set — Red vs Blue + a live flip-colour map = built-in narrative + the content hero; graded once the bench test proves electronic zone-scoring
~~ Capture the Zone ~~	Capture the Flag	Station	~~Best~~ → Superseded	~~Teams run objects to glowing base zones; most captures~~	Absorbed by TorqCapture (locked decision) — the flag-run survives as the Courier mode of the playlist; the shareable card is kept, the standalone game is retired
TorqSumo	Beyblade / Sumo	Arena	Good	Push rivals out of a ring; bracket → a final	Dead simple; a crowned final gives the day a climax
Balloon Battle	Splatoon-ish	Station	Good	Each car a balloon on a stick; pop rivals'; last standing	Cheap, silly, instant; slow-mo pops
Torq Bowling	Bowling	Station	Low	Nudge a ball into foam pins; score the frame	Precision but forgiving; satisfying — but low spectacle
~~The Maze~~	Time-trial	Station	Cut	Solo run vs the clock through a neon maze; leaderboard	Cut — head-to-head games out-content it; maze eats floor for one car
~~Mini-Golf~~	Mini-golf	Station	Cut	Nudge a ball through a turf course into the hole	Cut — too slow/low-spectacle for a content-first #1

Run set: 1 Best (marquee — TorqFall) + 3 Ungraded/prototype-gated arenas (TorqSiege, TorqCapture, TorqBall — each a full standalone event once its gate passes) + 2 Good (run — TorqSumo, Balloon Battle). Torq Bowling (Low) = optional filler if floor/budget allows. Capture the Zone is **absorbed into TorqCapture** (survives as the Courier mode). Maze + Mini-Golf dropped. Renders + clips per game live in **renders/** and the game deck.

Verified + changelog (2026-09-06): added **TorqCapture** as an Ungraded (pending bench test) Arena game and struck **Capture the Zone** as Superseded → absorbed into TorqCapture's Courier mode (locked decision from [[TorqCapture — Design Study v1]]; card kept, standalone retired). Updated the idea-level-scale note

(TorqSiege + TorqCapture both sit outside the scale, pending their prototype gates) and the run-set summary. Mirrors the same change in the Notion `games.csv`. Rebuild the Graded PDF from this source.

Second pass (2026-09-06, refresh): refreshed **TorqBall**'s "How it plays"/"Why it works" cells to reflect its now-full standalone doc set — standalone tournament arc (group → knockouts → final), the v1 mode playlist (Standard/Duel/Big Party), and the boost system (Plow/Scoop/Grabber/Turbo/Magnet on lit floor pads) — matching `[[TorqBall — Rulebook]]` and `[[TorqBall — Design Study v1]]`. No grade or type change.

Third pass (2026-09-06, examiner fix): corrected TorqBall's Idea Level/Type — it carries the identical unresolved, game-defining prototype gate (the Ball & Boards Test, plus a separate Grabber bench test — both stated in every TorqBall doc as "don't build until PASS") that puts TorqSiege and TorqCapture Ungraded, so TorqBall moves from **Best/Flagship** to **Ungraded (pending ball/boards test)/Arena**, matching the vault's own scale note (line 3) and the Notion `games.csv` row. Updated the idea-level note (line 3) and the run-set summary (line 21) to reflect only TorqFall as a currently graded Best game. TorqBall is promotable back to Best once the Ball & Boards Test and the Grabber bench test PASS — flip it here with a dated note, the same convention used for TorqSiege/TorqCapture.